

Program: _____ Center: _____

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[illegible]

- What does "brand" mean to you?
- How important is a company's brand to you?

- I can talk about jobs and work.
- I can exchange factual information and discuss future plans.
- I can give a supported argument about work-related processes that would benefit me and my employer.



Let's Explore!

Holly's gets a **push in the right direction***.

* To "*push in the right direction*" means to help someone make the correct decision.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

- Janet:** Alright, let's catch up on what's going on and decide on what steps to be taken next. We've got Kathy who will help us with some of the legal stuff. Miranda, could you start us off?
- Miranda:** Our press release was read by our spokesperson. All potential problems have been diagnosed and critical incident analysis was used to determine the risks we were faced with.
- Janet:** I believe all those issues were dealt with successfully, right?
- Miranda:** Yes. A social media team was created to monitor, post, and react to social media activity throughout the crisis.
- Janet:** Great. That way we will keep abreast of developments on the story. I am proud of the work we are doing. The processes and procedures that have been used confirm that this crisis is being well managed.
- Miranda:** You're right. However, the same cannot be said about Farmani and Holly's. We need good corporate governance and compliance in times of instability.
- Janet:** Correct. Due diligence is required in those areas in order to be successful. Farmani did not comply with the regulations and got us all into deep water.
- Miranda:** Janet, I'm a little concerned about the last report that was sent to me.
- Janet:** Could you be more specific?
- Miranda:** Holly's has been put on the radar after this incident. They have gained a lot of media exposure and this high exposure means a lot of potential damage to their brand.
- Janet:** I will warn Farmani. This exposure to risk is too great. The company's image is under public scrutiny. We need to do something about their brand.





Let's Practice!

It's time for a little bit of *damage control.

* "Damage control" is when steps are taken to minimize the effects of a mistake.

Instructions: Underline all the correct answers. Practice reading the answers aloud with a partner. Correct each other's pronunciation.

1. Which of the following sentences are in the passive voice?
 - a. Could you be more specific?
 - b. That way we will keep abreast of developments on the story.
 - c. Our press release was read by our spokesperson.
 - d. All potential problems have been diagnosed.
 - e. Critical incident analysis was used to determine the risks we were faced with.
 - f. We've got Kathy who will help us with some of the legal stuff.
 - g. A social media team was created.



Let's Practice!

The company goes through a tough time.

Instructions: Proofread the sentence. Underline the incorrect word. Write the correct sentence below. Practice saying the corrected sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

1. That way we will kept abreast of developments on the story.

2. We need good corporate government and compliance in times of instability.

3. Due dilettantes is required in those areas in order to be successful.

4. Farmani did not comply with the regulations and got us all into deep waiters.



Extension Activity

Write an imaginary press release.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Choose a corporate disaster or mistake that has appeared in the news recently (e.g. oil spill, automobile recall).
- Research the disaster and what was done to make it right.
- Write an imaginary press release (one paragraph) for the company.
- Include a description of what happened.
- Include a description of what will be done to fix the problem.
- Present your press release to a partner.

Self-Assessment

Yes No

I research corporate disasters.

☐ ☐

I use the passive voice to explain what was done.

☐ ☐

I use the future tense to explain how it will be fixed.

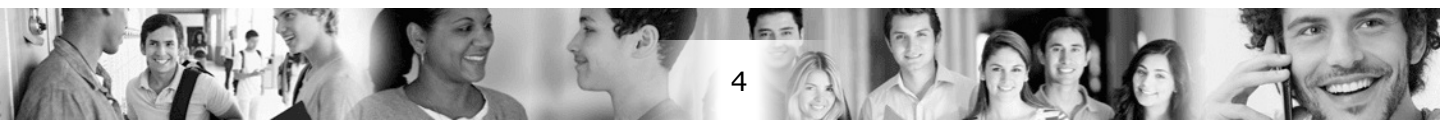
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I present my press release to a partner.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- **to keep abreast of** (expression): to stay informed about recently developments
e.g. We will keep abreast of developments on the story.
- **to be on the radar** (expression): to be noticed or important
e.g. Holly's has been put on the radar after this incident.
- **compliance** (noun): the state of obeying a particular set of rules or laws
e.g. Compliance is absolutely necessary at this time.
- **to comply with** (verb): to obey a particular set of rules or laws
e.g. Farmani did not comply with the regulations and got us all into deep water.
- **in deep water** (expression): in trouble or difficulty
e.g. If we don't comply, we will be in deep water.
- **due diligence** (expression): a reasonable amount of prudence, judgment, or effort
e.g. Due diligence is required in those areas in order to be successful.
- **instability** (noun): an unsettling state due to the possibility of unpredictable events or changes
e.g. There is a great deal of instability surrounding the company.
- **corporate governance** (expression): the way a company is managed, especially by those at the top
e.g. We need good corporate governance and compliance in times of instability.
- **public scrutiny** (expression): careful examination of something by the public
e.g. The company's image is under public scrutiny.





Learning Points

Passive Voice

In English, the sentence structure usually follows the same sequence: *subject + verb + object*. The subject comes first and the object comes last. However, if you don't want to pay special attention to the subject, you can change the word order. One way of doing this is by using the passive voice to change the focus in a sentence.

The passive voice allows you talk about an event or action from the point of view of the thing or person affected. Sometimes you can write a sentence without even mentioning the agent (who or what was responsible for the action).

This is how the passive is formed:

thing receiving action + be + past participle + (by) + (thing doing action)

Examples:

- *Our press release was sent out by our staff last night.*
- *Critical incident analysis was used to evaluate the risks.*
- *We were faced with many risks, but they were dealt with successfully.*
- *Due diligence is required in times like this.*

Future Simple and Simple Present

When dealing with a crisis, it is important to give a supported argument about work-related processes. We use the Present Simple and Future Simple to describe problems and talk about how you will deal with a situation.

a. Will

If something is planned to happen or it is likely to happen in the future, you use the modal *will* (or *going to*) before the base form of the verb.

- *Kathy will help us deal with most of the legal stuff.*
- *Monitoring social media will keep us updated on any developments on the story.*
- *I will definitely warn him about the crisis.*

b. Present Simple

We use the Present Simple to talk about our thoughts and feelings in general.

- *Let's catch up on the news.*
- *We need to decide on what to do next.*
- *I am proud of your good work.*
- *I'm concerned about the information on the last report.*
- *This exposure to risk is not good for us.*
- *The company's image is under a lot of pressure.*

